



A FIELD GUIDE FROM THE ROASTERY

The Roaster's Field Guide

Know your coffee, from seed to cup
— origins, roast, process, and the
science of a better brew.



Guided by the whole camp crew

"Nature Calls, Coffee Answers."



YOUR GUIDE

Sasquatch

Founder & Master Roaster



WELCOME TO THE FOREST

Pull Up a Log

Every great cup starts long before it reaches your mug — in the soil of a faraway hillside, in the hands of a farmer, in the roar of a drum roaster over an open fire. This guide is our way of handing you that whole story.

I'm **Sasquatch**, and I've spent more mornings than I can count coaxing green beans into something worth waking up for. Out here in the old-growth, we roast in small batches over a real flame because the forest taught us patience — and patience is what good coffee is made of.

WHO IT'S FOR

Newcomers & home baristas

Whether this is your first bag of specialty coffee or your fiftieth, you'll find something here to sharpen your palate and your pour.

HOW TO USE IT

Read it, then brew it

Skim a chapter before your next cup, or read cover to cover on a slow morning. Keep it on your phone for the next time you're standing in the coffee aisle.

Meet your guides

You won't walk this trail alone. Each chapter is hosted by a member of our camp crew — the same crew that roasts, tests, hauls, and inspects every bag we send out. They each know a different corner of the coffee world, and they're here to show you around.



SASQUATCH'S FIELD NOTE

Take your time with this one. Coffee rewards curiosity — the more you understand what's in the cup, the better every cup tastes.

Meet the Camp Crew

Six characters, six specialties. Here's who's guiding you through each leg of the journey.



Jackalope

Trail Guide

Origins. Knows every trail and every hillside. The Jackalope maps the growing regions and the flavors each one gives you.



Sasquatch

Founder & Master Roaster

Roasting. Master of the drum and the fire. Sasquatch explains what really happens to a bean between green and ground.



Yeti

Head of Operations

Processing. Runs the storeroom and the supply chain. Yeti breaks down how cherries become green coffee — washed, natural, honey.



Ollie

Coffee Scientist & Flavor Engineer

Brewing science. Beakers, brew charts, and a suspicious number of empty cups. Ollie makes extraction, TDS, and ratios make sense.



Mothman

Night Shift Manager

Freshness & the night shift. Keeps the roast schedule while the forest sleeps. Mothman covers degassing, storage, and staying fresh.



Simon

Camp Mascot & Quality Inspector

Tasting & terms. Official Coffee Quality Inspector. Simon translates the jargon so you can taste — and talk — like a pro.



OLLIE'S FIELD NOTE

Don't feel you must memorize any of it. Understanding beats memorizing every time — and it's a lot more fun.

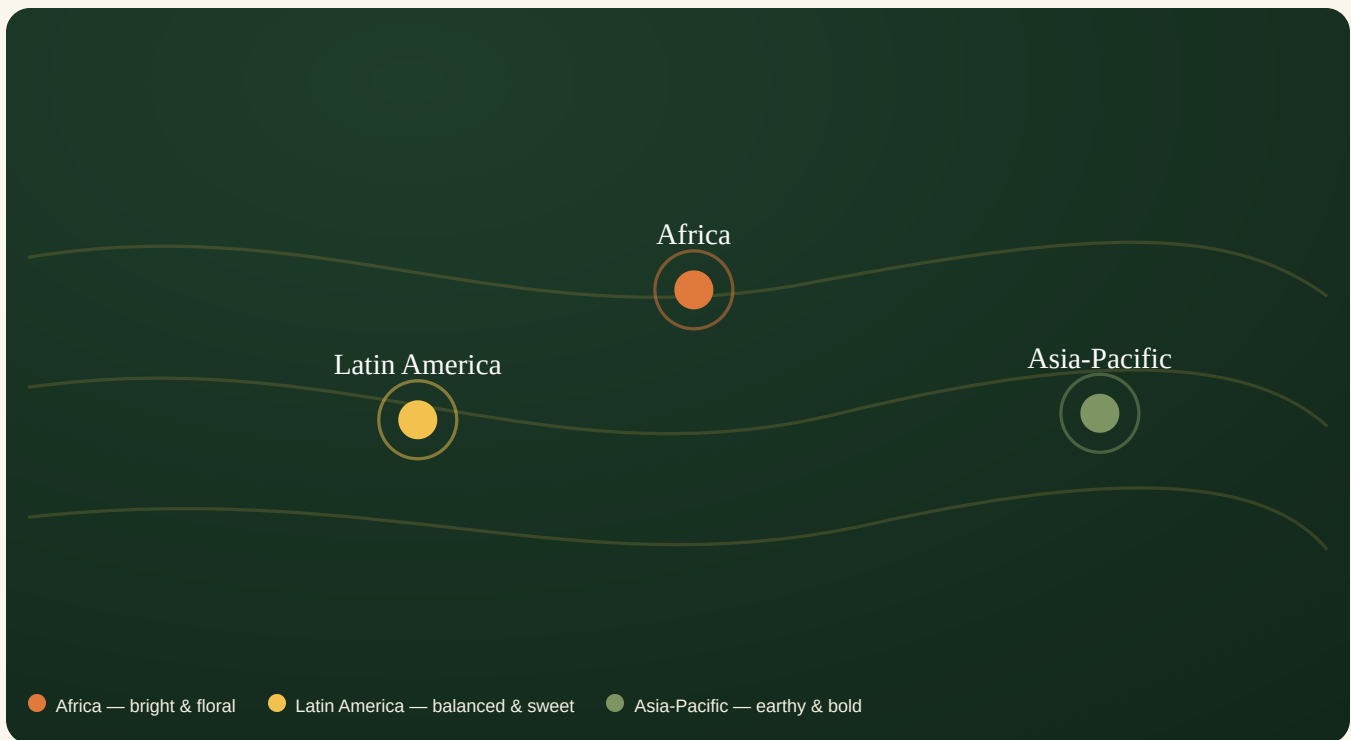


YOUR GUIDE
Jackalope
Trail Guide

01 CHAPTER ONE · ORIGINS

The Coffee Belt

Nearly all the world's coffee grows in a band around the equator — the "**Bean Belt**" between the Tropics of Cancer and Capricorn, where altitude, rainfall, and volcanic soil conspire to make something delicious. Where a coffee is grown shapes its flavor before a single bean is ever roasted. Follow my footprints.



Africa — the birthplace

Coffee was first discovered in **Ethiopia**, and East Africa still grows some of the most aromatic coffee on earth. Expect vivid acidity and a perfume-like quality.

JASMINE

BERGAMOT

BLUEBERRY

LEMON

BLACK CURRANT

ORIGIN	SIGNATURE FLAVORS	WHY IT TASTES THAT WAY
Ethiopia (Yirgacheffe, Guji)	Floral, citrus, stone fruit; naturals lean blueberry & strawberry	Heirloom varieties + high altitude = intense aromatics
Kenya (Nyeri, Kirinyaga)	Black currant, tomato, juicy bright acidity	SL-28 / SL-34 varieties + rich volcanic soil
Rwanda / Burundi	Red fruit, cola, silky body	High elevation, Bourbon varietal, careful washing



JACKALOPE'S FIELD NOTE

If you like a cup that tastes almost like tea or fruit — start in Africa. It's where coffee's wildest flavors live.

Latin America — the all-rounder

From Mexico down to Bolivia, this is the home of balance: gentle acidity, comforting sweetness, and flavors of chocolate, caramel, and nuts. It's where most people's "favorite everyday coffee" comes from.

ORIGIN	SIGNATURE FLAVORS	BEST FOR
Colombia	Caramel, red apple, balanced citrus	Everyday drip & pour-over
Brazil	Nutty, milk chocolate, low acidity	Espresso & milk drinks
Guatemala	Cocoa, baking spice, gentle fruit	Rich, comforting cups
Costa Rica	Honeyed sweetness, bright citrus	Clean, sweet pour-overs

Asia-Pacific — earthy & bold

Indonesia and its neighbors grow deep, heavy coffees with low acidity and a syrupy body — thanks in part to a unique regional process called **wet-hulling** (giling basah).

CEDAR

DARK CHOCOLATE

TOBACCO

EARTH

HERBAL

ORIGIN	SIGNATURE FLAVORS
Sumatra (Mandheling)	Earthy, herbal, cedar, full syrupy body, very low acidity
Sulawesi	Dark chocolate, warm spice, smooth
Papua New Guinea	Rounded fruit, chocolate, medium-full body



YETI'S FIELD NOTE

That heavy, earthy body in a Sumatra? That's the wet-hulling — I'll explain the process itself two pages on.



YOUR GUIDE

Sasquatch

Founder & Master Roaster

02 CHAPTER TWO · ROASTING

What the Fire Does

Green coffee smells like fresh grass and tastes like nothing you'd want. Roasting is where flavor is **born** — hundreds of aromatic compounds developing through heat, time, and a roaster's judgment. Two reactions do most of the work:

Maillard reaction

Sugars and amino acids react (~300–355°F) to build savory, nutty, bready, and roasty flavors — and the brown color.

Caramelization

Sugars break down (~340°F+) into sweet, toffee-like notes. Push too far and sweetness turns to smoke and ash.

The two "cracks"

As beans heat, they audibly crack twice — a roaster's landmarks. **First crack** (~385°F / 196°C) is like popcorn: the bean expands and releases steam. **Second crack** (~435°F / 224°C) is quieter and sharper, as oils migrate to the surface and the roast turns dark.



SASQUATCH'S FIELD NOTE

People think dark roast means 'strong.' It doesn't — it means the roast flavors dominate. Lighter roasts often carry MORE of the bean's origin character, and a touch more caffeine by weight.

Roast levels, decoded

There's no legal standard for these names, but here's how the camp reads them — and what to expect in the cup.

LEVEL	ALSO CALLED	END TEMP	IN THE CUP
Light	Cinnamon, Light City, Nordic	~356–401°F (just after 1st crack)	Bright acidity, floral/fruity, tea-like body, most origin character
Medium	City, American, Breakfast	~410–428°F	Balanced acidity & sweetness, caramel, rounded body — the crowd-pleaser
Medium-Dark	Full City	~437–446°F (start of 2nd crack)	Bittersweet, richer body, chocolate & toasted nut, a light sheen of oil
Dark	French, Italian, Vienna	~464–482°F	Bold, smoky, low acidity, oily surface; roast flavor leads over origin

MATCH ROAST TO METHOD

- **Light–Medium:** pour-over, drip, AeroPress
- **Medium:** just about anything
- **Medium-Dark:** espresso, moka pot
- **Dark:** milk drinks, cold brew, French press

FRESHNESS BEATS LEVEL

A fresh light roast and a fresh dark roast both beat a stale bag every time. Look for a **roast date**, not a "best by."



MOTHMAN'S FIELD NOTE

We roast to order through the night so your bag ships days — not months — after the fire. More on why that matters in my chapter.



YOUR GUIDE
Yeti
Head of Operations

03 CHAPTER THREE · PROCESSING

Cherry to Green Bean

A coffee "bean" is actually the seed of a fruit — the cherry. How the crew at origin removes that fruit and dries the seed has a **huge** effect on flavor, often as much as the region itself. Crates in, crates out — here's what happens in between.

PROCESS	HOW IT WORKS	TASTES LIKE
Washed (wet)	Fruit is stripped and beans are fermented & rinsed <i>before</i> drying	Clean, bright, crisp acidity — shows off origin & terroir
Natural (dry)	The whole cherry is dried in the sun; fruit removed <i>after</i>	Fruity, heavy body, wine & berry notes, more character (and variability)
Honey (pulped natural)	Skin removed but sticky mucilage left on during drying	Between the two — syrupy sweetness, rounded acidity
Wet-hulled (giling basah)	Indonesian method; hulled at high moisture	Low acidity, deep earthy, syrupy body
Anaerobic	Cherries ferment sealed, without oxygen	Bold, funky, boozy, tropical — experimental

A note on "honey" colors

Honey processing is graded by how much mucilage stays on and how much sun it sees: **white** and **yellow** honey (less mucilage, quicker dry) are cleaner and lighter; **red** and **black** honey (more mucilage, slower dry) are sweeter, heavier, and more intense.

WHITE HONEY

YELLOW HONEY

RED HONEY

BLACK HONEY



YETI'S FIELD NOTE

Same farm, same varietal, two processes — and they'll taste like different coffees. If a washed and a natural of the same origin are on the shelf, buy both and taste side by side. Best experiment there is.



YOUR GUIDE

Ollie

Coffee Scientist & Flavor Engineer

04 CHAPTER FOUR · BREWING SCIENCE

Extraction, Explained

I've tested this next part 143 times. Brewing is simply **using water to dissolve the good stuff out of ground coffee** — and doing it in the right amount. Get the balance right and the cup sings. Here's the science, minus the lab coat.

Extraction: the whole game

Roasted coffee is only about **28% soluble** — the rest is insoluble plant fiber. Of that soluble portion, we want to dissolve roughly **18–22%** of the coffee's mass. That's the "sweet spot" the specialty world calls ideal extraction.

IF YOUR COFFEE TASTES...	IT'S PROBABLY...	FIX IT BY...
Sour, salty, thin, weak	Under-extracted (too little dissolved)	Grind finer · hotter water · brew longer · more coffee
Bitter, harsh, hollow, drying	Over-extracted (too much dissolved)	Grind coarser · cooler water · brew shorter
Sweet, balanced, clear	Just right 🎯	Write down what you did!

Strength vs. extraction (not the same!)

Extraction is *how much* you pulled from the grounds. **Strength (TDS)** is *how concentrated* the final drink is. You can have a strong-but-sour cup (high strength, low extraction) or a weak-but-bitter one. Ratio controls strength; grind & time control extraction.



OLLIE'S FIELD NOTE

One variable at a time. Change the grind OR the ratio OR the temperature — never all three — or you'll never learn what did what.

Water is 98% of your coffee

Temperature

195–205°F (90–96°C) — just off the boil. Too hot scorches & over-extracts; too cool leaves it sour. No thermometer? Boil, then wait ~30 seconds.

Mineral content

Aim for moderate hardness (~**150 ppm**). Too soft tastes flat; too hard tastes chalky and mutes flavor. Filtered tap is usually great — distilled is not.

Brew ratios & times by method

A ratio like **1:16** means 1 gram of coffee to 16 grams (mL) of water. A kitchen scale is the single biggest upgrade you can make.

METHOD	RATIO	GRIND	WATER	TIME
Pour-over (V60)	1:16	Medium	200°F	2:30–3:30
Chemex	1:16–1:17	Medium-coarse	200°F	3:30–4:30
French press	1:15	Coarse	200°F	4:00
AeroPress	1:14–1:16	Medium-fine	185–200°F	1:00–2:00
Espresso	1:2 (18g → 36g)	Fine	200°F	25–32s
Cold brew	1:8 (concentrate)	Extra coarse	Cold	12–18 hr

The bloom

Fresh coffee is full of trapped CO₂. Pour just enough water to wet the grounds, wait **30–45 seconds**, and watch it "bloom" — that puff of bubbles is degassing. The fresher the roast, the bigger the bloom, and the better the extraction that follows.



OLLIE'S FIELD NOTE

No scale? A level tablespoon of beans is ~5–7g. But truly — a \$15 scale will fix more bad coffee than any gadget you own.

The Grind Size Guide

Grind is the fastest lever you have. Finer = more surface area = faster, stronger extraction. Coarser = slower, gentler. Match it to your brewer.

GRIND	FEELS LIKE	SIZE	BEST FOR
Extra fine	Powdered sugar	...	Turkish
Fine	Table salt	...	Espresso, moka pot
Medium-fine	Fine sand	...	AeroPress, pour-over cones
Medium	Coarse sand	...	V60, drip machines
Medium-coarse	Raw sugar	...	Chemex
Coarse	Sea salt / breadcrumbs	...	French press, cold brew

BURR, NOT BLADE

A **burr grinder** makes even grounds; a blade grinder makes chaos — dust *and* boulders that over- and under-extract at the same time. It's the second-best upgrade after a scale.

DIAL IT IN

Cup too bitter? Go **coarser**. Too sour or weak? Go **finer**. Adjust a little, taste, repeat. Your grinder's numbers are relative — your tongue is the real setting.



MOTHMAN'S FIELD NOTE

Grind right before you brew. Whole beans hold their aromatics for weeks; ground coffee starts losing them in minutes.



YOUR GUIDE
Mothman
Night Shift Manager

06 CHAPTER SIX · FRESHNESS

Keeping It Alive

I keep the campfire burning while the forest sleeps, and I'll tell you the same thing I tell every crate that leaves here: coffee is **food**, and fresh food tastes better. Here's how to protect what you paid for.

The freshness window

STAGE	TIMING	WHY
Rest after roast	~4–7 days (whole bean)	Beans need to degas CO ₂ before they brew their best
Peak flavor	~7–21 days from roast	The sweet spot — aromatics developed, gasses settled
Still good	Up to ~4–6 weeks	Slowly fading, but far from stale
Ground coffee	Minutes to hours	Surface area = fast staling. Grind per brew.

The four enemies

OXYGEN

MOISTURE

HEAT

LIGHT

- **Airtight & opaque.** Keep beans in a sealed, non-clear container — the bag's one-way valve is there to let CO₂ out, not air in.
- **Cool & dark.** A pantry shelf beats a sunny counter. Never store above the stove.
- **Don't live in the freezer.** Repeated in-and-out causes condensation. For long storage, freeze in small airtight portions and don't refreeze.
- **Buy what you'll drink in ~a month.** Fresher, smaller, more often beats a giant stale tub.



MOTHMAN'S FIELD NOTE

See a roast date on the bag? Good sign. See only a 'best by' a year out? That coffee has been sitting a while.



YOUR GUIDE

Simon

Camp Mascot & Coffee Quality Inspector

CHAPTER SEVEN · THE LANGUAGE

Glossary of the Trade

Talk coffee like you've been to the roastery. Here are the terms you'll actually run into.

Acidity

The bright, tangy, lively quality in a cup — a good thing in specialty coffee, not sourness.

Body

How heavy or thick the coffee feels in your mouth — from tea-like to syrupy.

Arabica

The sweeter, more complex, more prized coffee species. Most specialty coffee.

Robusta

Hardier species; harsher & more bitter, higher caffeine. Common in cheap blends & some espresso.

Single origin

Coffee from one place — country, region, or single farm — showing that origin's character.

Blend

Beans from multiple origins combined for balance, consistency, or a target flavor.

Terroir

How soil, altitude, and climate of a place shape a coffee's flavor.

Varietal

The genetic variety of the coffee plant (e.g. Bourbon, Typica, SL-28, Geisha).

Cupping

The standardized tasting ritual pros use to evaluate coffee — slurp, score, repeat.

Crema

The golden foam on top of a good espresso shot — emulsified oils and CO₂.

Bloom

The bubbling rise of fresh grounds when first wetted, as trapped CO₂ escapes.

TDS

Total Dissolved Solids — how concentrated (strong) the brewed drink is.

Extraction yield

The percentage of the coffee's mass dissolved into the water (aim ~18–22%).

First / second crack

Audible landmarks during roasting that mark developing roast levels.

Green coffee

Unroasted coffee seeds — grassy and dense, waiting for the fire.

Peaberry

A single rounded bean formed when only one seed develops in a cherry.

Micro-lot

A small, separately-tracked batch of exceptional coffee from a specific plot.

Degassing

Coffee releasing CO₂ after roasting — why fresh coffee needs a few days' rest.

Mouthfeel

The texture and weight of the coffee — silky, creamy, juicy, or thin.

Finish / aftertaste

The flavor that lingers after you swallow — long and sweet is the goal.



SIMON'S FIELD NOTE

Don't just read these — taste them. Next cup, ask: how's the acidity? the body? the finish? Naming what you taste is how your palate grows.

FROM ALL OF US AT CAMP

Now Go Taste the Difference

You've walked the whole trail — from a cherry on a far-off hillside, through the fire, to the grind and the pour. The best part? Every bag you open from here on will tell you a little more of its own story.



Pair this guide with any Sasquatch **single-origin** or **blend** and taste what you've learned — the origin, the roast, the process, all of it in one cup.

"Nature Calls, Coffee Answers."

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